

The Logic of the Fundamental Ideas in Brief Compass.

By

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Foreword

In this little book the author has endeavoured to give a short and clear presentation of his theistic logic. He has therein found occasion to bring out the nodal points on which the scientific dispute between pantheism and theism must essentially turn.

R. Nielsen.

Introduction

At the present stage of philosophy's development it becomes a scientific necessity to treat logic from three essentially different points of view.

In order to develop the laws of thinking, one must keep to thinking itself. But thinking is a human activity of spirit; we must learn what thinking is from our own thinking. It lies near, then, to regard the human being as the thinking subject, to reflect upon the mutual relations of the acts of thought, and to mark the forms necessary for the understanding, the intellectual traces which advancing thought deposits. This point of view is characteristic of *formal logic*.

It is, however, so far from being the case that the finite understanding should command the demands of thought, that these must on the contrary be said to command the thinker; there shall be thinking, but when the thinking is consistent it is for the rest indifferent who it is that thinks — whether it be a human being or a god or perhaps pure being. The emphasis falls on the thinking. For thinking's own sake, on the other hand, it is of importance to fix the eye on that which is thought, on the universally necessary content; for the content of thought and the form of thought are determined by one another. This point of view is characteristic of the *speculative* or, to use a perhaps still more telling expression, *the immanent logic*.

These two principal forms of logic, of which the first has an Aristotle, the second a Hegel, as supreme representative, may with reason be said to enjoy a well-deserved recognition in science.

That they cannot well be reconciled with one another, but stand in a most serious dispute concerning the very first principles of thinking, notably the principle of contradiction, is certainly less commendable; but they will both maintain their place: the one will not be able to displace the other.

In order that each of the contending parties may come fully into its right, it is in our judgment necessary that yet a third principal form be introduced. But before we attempt to prove the correctness of this assertion, we consider it expedient to bring the architectonic opposition between the two doctrinal edifices nearer to intuition by prefacing an outline corresponding to each of them.

Formal Logic.

Formal logic, or the doctrine of the abstractly necessary thought-forms, divides into the doctrine of *Concept*, *Judgment* and *Inference*.

Concept.

Thinking, which is already present in sensation, raises itself forth as it dissolves the immediate sense-images, forms by comparison and abstraction a *general image*, holds it fast in the *word*, makes clear to itself the essential marks that necessarily belong together, and transforms it into a *concept* (concept-analysis, definition).

The sum of the determinations belonging to a concept constitutes the concept's *content*; the number of the objects to which it finds application designates its *extension*. (Inverse relation between content and extension; superordinate and subordinate concepts; genus- and species-concepts.)

Judgment.

The concept finds its pure logical expression only in language: words are joined into sentences, and in sentences judgments are uttered. The sentence whose form expresses a concept is a *logical judgment*. In order to express the concept in this form, the judgment must formally indicate: the *Subject*, the representation that is to be determined; the *Predicate*, the determining representation; and the *Copula*, the determining word of connection.

From the subject's connection with the predicate, determined by the copula, it follows that the judgment can be separated into a plurality of logically different judgments, and judgments are divided: according to *quality* into affirmative, negative and infinite; according to *quantity* into singular, particular and general; according to *relation* into categorical, hypothetical and disjunctive; according to *modality* into assertoric, problematic and apodictic.

If the predicate proceeds from the subject with universal logical necessity, the judgment is *analytic*; if the predicate can be joined to the subject only through a particular intuition or experience, the judgment is *synthetic* (synthetic judgments *a priori*; Kant's problem).

Inference.

The judgment must be grounded; its validity must be seen into; the act of thinking whereby the validity of one judgment is derived from one or more other judgments is a *logical inference*. If the inference has only one antecedent proposition (premise),

it is called *immediate*; if it has several premises, it is called *mediate* (the requisites of inference).

The mediate inferences are divided into: the *categorical*, conditioned by the subsumption of the subordinate concept's mark (*nota notæ*) under the superordinate (syllogistic figures); the *hypothetical*, which rest on the dependence of the conditioned upon its condition (*modus ponens* and *modus tollens*); and the *disjunctive*, which are grounded on this, that the members of a whole are mutually so related that when one is expressly posited the rest are excluded (*modus ponendo tollens*), and that when the rest are excluded the one remaining must be posited (*modus tollendo ponens*).

By treating the doctrine of proof and method, formal logic resolves itself into a general doctrine of knowledge and of science.

The Immanent Logic.

The immanent logic, which is a dialectical development of the system of the categories (the thought-forms inherent in all being), divides into the doctrine of *Being*, *Essence* and *Concept*.

Being.

Universal being is one with universal thinking; but the unity of thinking and being is, in its most abstract form, void of content: pure *Being* is the same as pure *Nothing*. But *Nothing*, as non-being, is nevertheless different from *Being*. That *Being* both is and is not *Nothing* means that *Being* unceasingly passes over into *Nothing*, and *Nothing* into *Being*: this transition is *Becoming*.

In *Becoming*, *Nothing* is a limit for *Being*, and *Being* for *Nothing*. *Being* limited by its *Nothing* is a *being*, a *Something*, and *Nothing* determined by *Being*, an *Other*. But the *Other* is itself *Something*, and *Something* in turn *Other*; *Something* passes by its own limit over into *Other*, and *Other* into *Something*: this transition is *Alteration*.

In *alteration* *Something* is one with its *Other*; this is the *Unchangeable* in the *One*; but *Something* is also different from the *Other*; this is the *Changeable* in the *One*. It is thus the *Unchangeable* that is altered; but precisely by being altered it keeps itself unaltered: under all *alteration* there is something *unchangeable*.

Essence.

The *Unchangeable* that is seen in the *Changeable* is *Essence*; the *Changeable* through which the *Essence* is seen is *Semblance*: the alternating shine of *Semblance* and *Essence* is *Reflection*.

In its identity with the Essence, the Semblance is *Phenomenon*; in its difference from the Phenomenon, the Essence is *Ground*. The Phenomenon goes to the ground; it belongs to Semblance and must be reflected into its Essence. But in that the Phenomenon receives the Essence for its ground, it becomes grounded and is posited as *Existence*.

Existence reflected into itself is an *existent*, a *Thing*; but the Thing can be reflected into itself only by reflecting its existence into other existing things: the determinations corresponding to these reflections are *Properties*.

In this mutual reflecting the things dissolve into the properties, and everything becomes unstable. But the unstable presupposes something subsisting which cannot be dissolved, because its subsistence infinitely confirms itself in the alternation of the unstable; this subsisting something is the *Substance*, and the modes of appearance alternating in instability are the *Accidents*.

The relation between the Substance and its Accidents is a *relation of causality*: the Substance is *Cause*, the original matter; the Accidents are *Effects*. But the Cause has its substantial expression in the Effect; without Effect, no Cause: by making the Cause a Cause, the Effect is itself Substance — thus a Cause that makes the Cause an Effect.

In *Reciprocity* the Effect is Cause, and the Cause Effect; and in that all the moments of actuality contained in the Essence are, under all-sided reciprocity, developed in full totality, the Essence developed in the totality is Concept.

Concept.

The self-comprehending totality is, in its unity with itself, the *Universal*; in its difference from itself, *the Particular*; in its totalized determinateness through itself, the *Singular*.

The Concept's self-development is its *ground-division* (the Judgment). By virtue of the ground-division, the totality in its first immediate being, the Singular, is posited as the *Subject*, and the totality in the reflected form, the Universal, as the *Predicate*: the Subject is what the Predicate is; the *Singular* is the *Universal*.

But in that the Singular is comprehended as the Universal, and the Universal as the Singular, the opposed members of the concept-separation become mutually comprehended, in reciprocal determination, as the *Particular*.

The outer members of the ground-division, the *Extremes*, have thus in the Concept's self-development deposited a *middle member*, a *Medium*, in which they can be mediated. This mediation is the *Inference*.

The Concept's self-mediation through Judgment and Inference is its *Subjectivity*; the immediacy regained through the mediation is its *Objectivity*.

As immediate, existing totality the Concept is Object — and, by virtue of the ground-division, an infinite manifold of existing objects.

The objects in their outward, indifferent mutuality are *mechanical*, acting upon one another by *pressure* and *impact*. The separation of motion and rest which herewith enters is a relative appearing of the *absolute Mechanics*, in which motion is rest, and rest motion.

Beneath the indifference of the mechanical objects there hides a *difference*, which comes to light in chemical attraction. The difference of the objects brings with it a tension, which is equalized in *the chemical product*. But the product, in which the difference is neutralized, must as the *Neutral* dissolve again into difference, and the *process* begins anew.

In the chemical process the Concept goes forth out of its own presuppositions, sublates the presuppositions in their result, in order again to sublate the result in the presuppositions. The objective Concept is now master over the material: the result anticipated in the presuppositions is *End*, the presuppositions are *Means*, the movement is *teleological*.

The teleological Concept, comprehending itself in its own elements, is a form that gives itself content, a content that gives itself form: in this its *absolute unity* of form and content, of *Subjective and Objective*, of end and means, the Concept is *Idea*.

From the outlines here set forth it will be seen how divergent the directions are. In formal logic the human being, the thinking subject, is from first to last occupied with his own acts of thought; it is the human being himself who abstracts, reflects, judges and infers. But for just that reason the thought-forms are empty forms, and the acts of thought finite, psychologically conditioned operations of the understanding. The object of thinking falls outside the thinking. Here is an insurmountable gulf between the subjective and the objective, and the thinker has only to watch that in his judgment about the things he does not come into contradiction with himself. To secure the unity of the thinkable and the possible, one holds fast to *the principle of contradiction*; but that the principle of contradiction affords no reliable guarantee of the objective validity of subjective thinking, the *antinomies* in Kant's Critique of Pure Reason have sufficiently shown.

The gulf between the subjective and the objective disappears in the immanent logic, which abstracts from the thinking subjectivity and lets Being think itself by the help of contradiction and negation. That Being is Nothing is indeed a contradiction, for Being must necessarily exclude non-being. But the non-being that is excluded is precisely the negation that lies in Being's own concept. That the Unchangeable is changeable, that the Essence is Semblance, that the Cause is Effect, are sheer contradictions. But these contradictions make it precisely evident how the thinking that is entangled in finite representations deceives itself by keeping the content of what is outside itself. The Changeable is the Unchangeable's indwelling negation, just as the Semblance is the Essence's, and the Effect the Cause's.

Nevertheless it must not be overlooked that the immanent method of developing the matter, despite its epoch-making significance, also has its weak sides. Negation

is originally a thought-determination, not a determination of being. What is can, in its immediacy, negate neither itself nor another being. Negations, contradictions and resolutions of contradictions are acts of thought which hold of what is only under the express condition that Being is thought. But in order that this condition can be fulfilled, the invoked unity of thinking and being must from the beginning be grounded upon a corresponding opposition. Pure Being is Nothing, when Being is thought; but Nothing and Being fall nonetheless each under its own sphere: Nothing under thinking, and so under the subjective; and Being under actuality, and so under the objective.

If the dispute between the two recognized points of view is not to become endless and unfruitful, a third point of view must be chosen, from which it becomes possible to reconcile the contending parties. It must then be conceded to formal logic that the thoughts proceed from a thinking subjectivity; but it must at the same time be conceded to the immanent logic that it is not a finite but an infinite thinking that comprehends existence. Formal logic must be right in this, that there is a characteristic difference between the subjective in thinking and the objective in actuality; but the logic of immanence retains its right in this, that the opposition of the subjective and the objective rests upon identity of thinking and being. It is this third point of view that is chosen in *the Logic of the Fundamental Ideas*.

As regards the origin of thoughts, only three assumptions are possible: 1) that they proceed from a finite subjectivity; 2) that they develop themselves out of universal being; 3) that they spring from an infinite, absolute subjectivity. As regards the relation between thinking and being, there are likewise only three assumptions possible: 1) that it is a finite opposition, be it in agreement or in discord; 2) that the unity sublates the opposition; 3) that the unity grounds the opposition.

For the all-sided development of logic the three points of view here set up are necessary; but more than these three are, so far as principles are concerned, impossible.

The Logic of the Fundamental Ideas

develops the ideal essentiality of the thought-forms under *the Idea of Knowledge*, the forms of being corresponding to actuality under *the Idea of Power*, and points out the dualistic unity of the ideal and the real content in *the Idea of Truth*.

The fundamental separation of the three Ideas is especially motivated by regard to the one-sidedness of the immanent logic.

In order that thinking shall be possible, there must be something that is thought, hence something that thinking itself posits, presupposes and produces; this is *the Ideal*. But in order that actuality, the actual world, can have validity, there must be something other than thinking: something that is not thought, but about which there is thinking;

something whereby thinking is determined, but which it does not itself produce; this is *the Real*. The difference between the Ideal and the Real points to a decisive difference between Knowledge and Power: the Ideal is a knowledge-determination, the Real a power-determination.

It is universally acknowledged that everything in the world must have a ground; herein lies that the existent must rest upon a non-existent. The ground by itself is not existent; it has existence only in the existence which it grounds. The ground is an *ideality*; the thing, the actual object, is a *reality*. The ideality can be thought, and there can be thinking about the reality; but the reality itself cannot be thought; to think the reality is to sublate it and transform it into ideality.

The immanent logic has shown excellently what ideality is, but it has entirely forgotten what reality is.

When the finite, the existing positive, is to hold itself abstractly, as the Real, over against the infinite as the negative, the Ideal, then it is easy to see that the ideality must swallow up the reality. For by having the infinite as its limit, the finite itself becomes infinite; but thereby the infinite, which from its side receives the finite as its limit, becomes precisely finite. In that the opposed qualities have thus mutually negated one another, they have, by the negation of the negation, at the same time affirmed one another, and have thereby both obtained the same ideality: the finite's ideality is its sublation and confirmation in the infinite; just so the infinite's ideality is its sublation and confirmation in the finite. But the reality has vanished.

The immanent logic has an altogether false conception of reality. In its zeal to comprehend the object, it neglects to form an actual concept of the actual object. The actual object is not an ideality but a reality, a phenomenon of power, which no thinking is able to produce. Not even the divine thought would be capable of thinking an actual stone; for when the stone is thought, it is transformed into ideality and ceases to exist.

It is with respect to this that the Logic of the Fundamental Ideas has enforced the dualistic opposition of Knowledge and Power. If Power is to pass straightway into Knowledge, then it is over with the reality of existence; the things become semblance, and the actual world dissolves into a metaphysical system of divine thoughts. If Knowledge is to vanish into Power, then ideality is lost. Realism sinks down into a crude materialism, which makes the Ideal a semblance of the Real, the spiritual an empty after-glow of the corporeal.

But when all the ideal content of being is elucidated in *the Idea of Knowledge*, and the real content of actuality passes into *the Idea of Power*, then it follows of itself that the unity of the opposition must have its complete expression in the Idea of Ideas, the all-sided Idea, which saturates thinking with ideality and upholds the reality of actuality — i.e. in *the Idea of Truth*.

A. Knowledge.

B. Power.

C. Truth.

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